

INTERROGATION RECORD: HESPER WRENFIELD, OUTRIDER

Copied into the ash-black register. The original leaves are smoke-stained, and several answers have been marked as unfit for repetition.

Subject: Hesper Wrenfield Standing: Outrider Birth: 404 AS
Classification: A minor figure of the Ashen Era Description: No canonical physical features are established for Hesper Wrenfield; their visual identity is limited to their role as an Outrider.
Demeanor: No canonical temperament is established for Hesper Wrenfield.

- - -

EXAMINER: State your name for the record.

HESPER WRENFIELD: Hesper Wrenfield.

EXAMINER: Your station?

HESPER WRENFIELD: Outrider.

EXAMINER: Your birth year?

HESPER WRENFIELD: 404 AS.

EXAMINER: You understand why you have been brought here?

HESPER WRENFIELD: I understand that a door was opened, and I was told to enter.

EXAMINER: That is not an answer.

HESPER WRENFIELD: It is the answer I possess.

[Here the examiner has drawn a line through the margin. The ink has been pressed so hard that the page is torn.]

EXAMINER: You serve whom?

HESPER WRENFIELD: I serve as an Outrider.

EXAMINER: I asked whom.

HESPER WRENFIELD: You asked a different question after I answered the first.

EXAMINER: What did you carry beyond the ash road?

HESPER WRENFIELD: The road carried itself. I carried nothing worth your seal.

EXAMINER: Did you see the signal?

HESPER WRENFIELD: I saw many things.

EXAMINER: Did you see the signal?

HESPER WRENFIELD: If I did, then it has already been seen.

[A pause is entered here. No duration is supplied. The recorder notes that the lamp guttered, though no draft is mentioned.]

EXAMINER: Name the hand that gave the order.

HESPER WRENFIELD: Orders have hands only when written.

EXAMINER: Was it written?

HESPER WRENFIELD: You have the paper.

EXAMINER: The paper bears no name.

HESPER WRENFIELD: Then it bears no answer.

EXAMINER: You mistake refusal for safety.

HESPER WRENFIELD: You mistake noise for truth.

[At this point the record becomes irregular. Several questions are preserved only as black strokes. No confession is entered. No accusation is formally concluded.]

EXAMINER: One final matter. Are you Hesper Wrenfield, minor figure of the Ashen Era, born in 404 AS, serving as an Outrider?

HESPER WRENFIELD: That is what your record says.

EXAMINER: And what do you say?

HESPER WRENFIELD: I have said my name.

CLOSING NOTE: The subject's canonical physical features remain unestablished. No canonical temperament is established. The record therefore permits no reliable description beyond the stated role: Outrider.